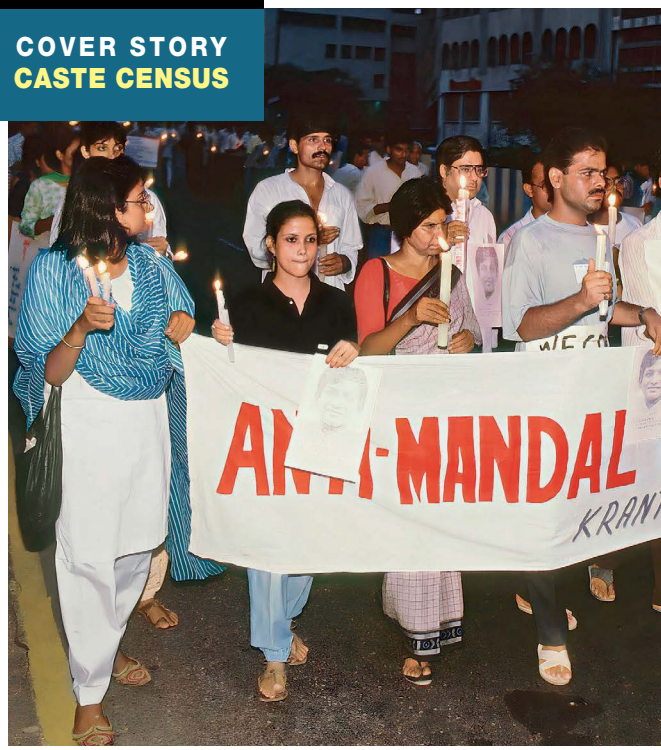



SHARAD SAXENA

# AN UNKNOWN UNIVERSE

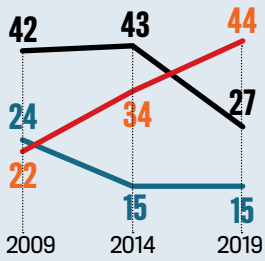
**THERE HAS BEEN NO COUNT OF THE OBCs SINCE THE 1931 CENSUS, WHICH PEGGED THEIR POPULATION AT 52 PER CENT**

**WHY OBC VOTES MATTER**

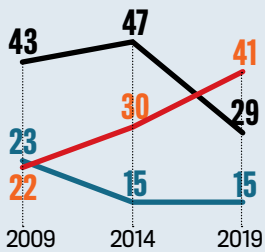
## BJP'S BACKBONE

OBC support for the BJP has doubled in 10 years and come down substantially for the Congress/other parties

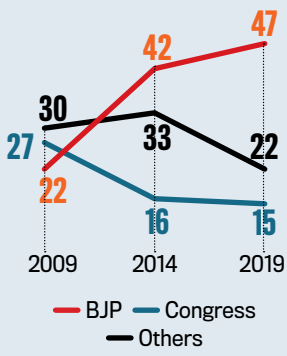
**OVERALL OBCs (%)**




**'UPPER' OBCs (%)**




**'LOWER' OBCs (%)**

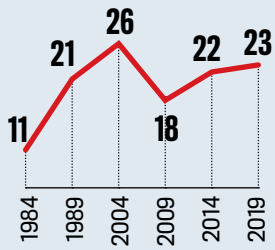



*Source: Post-poll survey by CSDS, 2019*

Per India Today Axis-My India exit poll, **58%** OBC voters supported the BJP in the 2019 LS polls

## OBC MPs IN THE LOK SABHA

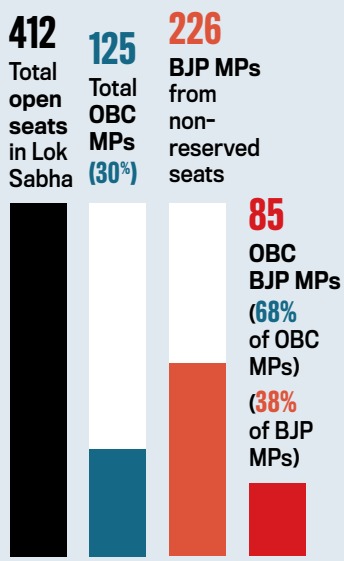
OBC count has fluctuated between a historic high of 26 per cent in 2004 and just 11 per cent in 1984




*Figures in %*

## HOW THE BJP HAS MASTERED THE OBC GAME

In the current Lok Sabha, the BJP displays a significant representation of the OBCs




27 of the 77 ministers in the Union cabinet are from OBC communities

ervation in government jobs and educational institutes; the OBCs 27 per cent. The Bihar caste census is certain to strengthen the demand for an increase in the quota for backward classes as well as a rejig of the existing reservation structure across the country.

With this bombshell, not only does Nitish hope to burnish his credentials as a messiah of the OBCs but also to assert that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) are interested only in co-opting them in the larger Hindutva agenda, doing little for their socio-economic uplift. To the newly-minted Opposition alliance, which has come together under the banner of the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance, or INDIA, the Bihar survey has handed a solid electoral plank to enter the Lok Sabha polls within another seven months. Opposition parties are, in fact, calling it Mandal 2.0, as a follow-up to Version 1.0 when the V.P. Singh government implemented the Mandal Commission's recommendations in 1990, sending national politics into a chaotic tailspin. The release of the Bihar census is likely to set off a chain reaction in other states. At stake will be more than nine million government jobs at the central and state levels, and admissions in educational institutes, including 2.3 million seats in engineering colleges and 100,000-plus in medical institutions. It threatens to open a Pandora's box that could see every caste in the country scrambling for a piece of the reservations pie.

## WHAT MANDAL 2.0 SIGNIFIES

If Mandal 1.0 saw the decimation of the Congress and the rise of regional parties such as the Samajwadi Party (SP) and the Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) in Uttar